

Working conditions of higher education staff and related psychological aspects

More detailed information on the research can be found in the [Informed consent of the research participant](#).

Please refer only to higher education institutions in Austria. If you work at more than one higher education institution in Austria, please refer to your primary institution, i.e. the one you consider to be your main institution or where you work more hours.

If you do not wish to answer a question, simply skip it.

Thank you for your willingness to participate in this research.

Background information about you and your work situation

1. 1. Gender:

Mark only one oval.

☐ Male

☐ Female

☐ Other

2. 2. Age (in years):

3. 3. Nationality:

4. 4. Current marital (partnership) status:

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Married/Registered Partnership
- ☐ In a relationship (unmarried)
- ☐ Single (currently without a partner)
- ☐ Divorced (currently without a partner)
- ☐ Widowed (currently without a partner)

5. 5. Do you currently care for underage children or dependent relatives?

Tick all that apply.

- ☐ No
- ☐ Yes, I care for one or more underage children
- ☐ Yes, I care for one or more dependent relatives

6. 6. The type of higher education institution where you primarily work:

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Public university
- ☐ Private university/Private university college
- ☐ University of applied sciences
- ☐ Public university college of teacher education
- ☐ Private university college of teacher education

7. 7. Subject area of the faculty (higher education institution) where you primarily work:

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Natural sciences
- ☐ Technical sciences
- ☐ Agricultural, forestry and veterinary sciences
- ☐ Healthcare, medical and pharmaceutical sciences
- ☐ Humanities and social sciences
- ☐ Economic sciences
- ☐ Law
- ☐ Pedagogy, teacher training
- ☐ Culture and art
- ☐ Sport sciences
- ☐ Unspecified, cannot be categorised (e.g. university-wide departments such as the rectorate, academic library, etc.)
- ☐ Other: _____

8. 8. Duration of your current employment contract at the higher education institution where you primarily work:

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Permanent employment (tenured)
- ☐ Continuous employment (no preset term, but no guarantee of permanence)
- ☐ Fixed-term employment - with permanent/continuous employment prospects (tenure-track)
- ☐ Fixed-term employment - without permanent/continuous employment prospects
- ☐ Casual/hourly contract according to work tasks
- ☐ Other: _____

9. 9. Extent of employment in higher education (in hours/week, aggregated for all higher education institutions where you work):

Mark only one oval.

☐ 40 hours/week (full-time employment with one employer)

☐ Other: _____

10. 10. Actual average weekly working hours in higher education (in a typical semester week):

If the actual working hours differ from the weekly extent of your employment (see question 9 above), please indicate the actual average number of hours per week you spend on activities related to your employment in higher education.

Mark only one oval.

☐ The actual working hours roughly correspond to the extent of my employment.

☐ Other: _____

11. 11. Average gross monthly income from your employment in higher education:

Please also take into account any exceptional bonuses over and above your regular monthly salary that you receive during the year (e.g. 13th and 14th salary, publication bonuses, etc.).

12. 12. Do you hold a leadership position at a higher education institution?

Tick all that apply.

☐ No

☐ Yes, at the institution, faculty, or department level

☐ Yes, at the research team level (third-party funded research projects)

13. 13. How influential are you in helping to shape key academic policies at your institution at the level of department or similar unit?

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Not ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very influential

14. 14. Do you currently have another (paid) job outside higher education?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ No, I only work in Austrian higher education *Skip to question 16*
- ☐ Yes, I work in the public sector or government
- ☐ Yes, I work in the private sector or industry
- ☐ Yes, I work in a non-profit organisation
- ☐ Yes, I am self-employed
- ☐ Yes, I work in more than one area mentioned above
- ☐ Other: _____

15. 14.1. Actual average weekly working hours outside higher education (in a typical semester week):

16. 15. Your current position at the higher education institution, where you primarily work:

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Non-academic
- ☐ University Professor *Skip to question 20*
- ☐ Professor at a university of applied sciences *Skip to question 20*
- ☐ Professor at a university college of teacher education *Skip to question 20*
- ☐ Professor Extraordinarius (Außerordentliche Professur) *Skip to question 20*
- ☐ Associate Professor (Assoziierte Professur) *Skip to question 20*
- ☐ Assistant Professor (Assistenz-Professur) *Skip to question 20*
- ☐ University Assistant (Post-Doc) *Skip to question 20*
- ☐ University Assistant (Prae-Doc) *Skip to question 20*
- ☐ Senior Lecturer, Senior Scientist or Senior Artist *Skip to question 20*
- ☐ Research Fellow *Skip to question 20*
- ☐ Lecturer *Skip to question 20*
- ☐ Other: _____

17. 16. Please choose the category that best fits your job description:

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Department assistant, manager assistant
- ☐ Laboratory technician
- ☐ Librarian, archivist
- ☐ Facility management
- ☐ Information and communication technologies
- ☐ Student support services
- ☐ Economics, finance, or human resources
- ☐ Project management
- ☐ Legal and control
- ☐ Marketing and public relations
- ☐ Science and knowledge transfer
- ☐ Foreign affairs
- ☐ Other administrative staff
- ☐ Other: _____

18. 17. The highest level of education attained:

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Elementary school
- ☐ High school/Secondary school
- ☐ Bachelor's degree
- ☐ Master's degree
- ☐ Doctoral degree
- ☐ Other: _____

19. 18. Total length of your career in Austrian higher education in years:

Please provide the total length of your career from the start of your first employment in any Austrian higher education institution; please exclude any extended breaks from work (e.g. parental leave) or periods when you worked in another sector or abroad.

Mark only one oval.

☐ I have been working in Austrian higher education for less than 1 year.

☐ Other: _____

Skip to question 30

Please estimate how many hours per week you spend on average on the following activities (in a typical semester week):

Aggregated for all jobs in higher education

20. 1. Teaching (classroom instruction, preparation of instructional materials and lesson plans, advising students, reading and evaluating student work, examination management, etc.)

21. 2. Research (reading literature, designing and conducting experiments, collecting and analysing data, writing articles or other scientific texts, etc.)

22. 3. Activities related to externally funded research projects (searching for information on available funding sources, preparation of grant applications and project reports, project management and administration, etc.)

23. 4. Organisational and administrative activities (organising and attending meetings, dealing with tasks and documents not directly related to teaching, research, or externally funded research projects, etc.)

How would you evaluate each of the following facilities and resources you need to support your work at the higher education institution, where you primarily work?

24. 1. Facilities and technological equipment (offices, classrooms, laboratories, computers, projectors, teaching software)

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Inad	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Excellent

25. 2. Research equipment (instruments, tools, materials, software for working with data)

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Inad	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Excellent

26. 3. Availability of scientific literature (access to up-to-date scientific articles and books)

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Inad	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Excellent

27. 4. Personnel support (support from secretarial, administrative and technical staff, laboratory technicians, etc.)

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Inad	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Excellent

28. 5. Opportunities for personal and professional development (offer and availability of professional courses and internships, opportunities to participate at conferences and other professional events)

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Inad	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Excellent

29. 6. Availability of resources for research funding

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Inad	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Excellent

Working environment at the higher education institution

Please indicate to what extent the below-mentioned statements apply to you personally.

For this part of the questionnaire, please rate the statements using the following scale:

1 = I strongly disagree

2 = I somewhat disagree

3 = I'm in the middle

4 = I somewhat agree

5 = I strongly agree

Perceived pressure

30. 1. At my institution, there is a strong performance orientation.

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
I str	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	I strongly agree

31. 2. I feel like I can be myself at my job.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

32. 3. At work, I often feel like I have to follow other people's commands.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

33. 4. If I could choose, I would do things at work differently.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

34. 5. The tasks I have to do at work are in line with what I really want to do.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

35. 6. I feel free to do my job the way I think it could best be done.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

36. 7. In my job, I feel forced to do things I do not want to do.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

Quality of leadership

My immediate superior ...

37. 1. ... makes sure that the members of staff have good development opportunities.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

38. 2. ... gives high priority to job satisfaction.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

39. 3. ... is good at work planning.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

40. 4. ... is good at solving conflicts.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

Work team

41. 1. There is a good atmosphere between myself and my colleagues.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

42. 2. There is good co-operation between the colleagues at work.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

43. 3. I feel part of a community at my place of work.

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
I str	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	I strongly agree

Job satisfaction

For this part of the questionnaire, please answer the questions using the following scale:

1 = Very unsatisfied

2 = Unsatisfied

3 = Neither satisfied, nor unsatisfied

4 = Satisfied

5 = Very satisfied

Regarding your work at the higher education institution in general. How pleased are you with:

44. 1. ... your work prospects?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Very	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Very satisfied

45. 2. ... the physical working conditions (e.g. facilities, equipment, physical working environment)?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Very	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Very satisfied

46. 3. ... the way your abilities are used?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Very	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Very satisfied

47. 4. ... your salary?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Very	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Very satisfied

48. 5. ... your job as a whole, everything taken into consideration?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Very	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Very satisfied

Work motivation

Please indicate to what extent are the following propositions reasons for you to make efforts/to get involved in your job (at the higher education institution).

For this part of the questionnaire, please rate the statements using the following scale:

1 = I strongly disagree

2 = I disagree

3 = I somewhat disagree

4 = I'm in the middle

5 = I somewhat agree

6 = I agree

7 = I strongly agree

Why do you or would you put efforts into your current job?

49. 1. I don't, because I really feel that I'm wasting my time at work.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

I strongly disagree ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ I strongly agree

50. 2. To get others' approval (e.g., supervisor, colleagues, family, students...).

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

I str ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ I strongly agree

51. 3. Because others will reward me financially only if I put enough effort in my job (e.g., employer, supervisor...).

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

I strongly disagree ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ I strongly agree

52. 4. Because I have to prove to myself that I can.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

I strongly disagree ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ I strongly agree

53. 5. Because I personally consider it important to put efforts in this job.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

I strongly disagree ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ I strongly agree

54. 6. Because I have fun doing my job.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

I str ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ I strongly agree

55. 7. I do little because I don't think this work is worth putting efforts into.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

I strongly disagree ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ I strongly agree

56. 8. Because others will respect me more (e.g., supervisor, colleagues, family, students...).

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

I strongly disagree ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ I strongly agree

57. 9. Because others offer me greater job security if I put enough effort in my job (e.g., employer, supervisor...).

Mark only one oval.

I strongly disagree I strongly agree

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

58. 10. Because it makes me feel proud of myself.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

I strongly disagree ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ I strongly agree

59. 11. Because putting efforts in this job aligns with my personal values.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

I str ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ I strongly agree

60. 12. Because what I do in my work is exciting.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

I str ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ I strongly agree

61. 13. I don't know why I'm doing this job, it's pointless work.

Mark only one oval.

[illegible]

62. 14. To avoid being criticized by others (e.g., supervisor, colleagues, family, students...).

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

I strongly disagree I strongly agree

63. 15. Because I risk losing my job if I don't put enough effort in it.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

I strongly disagree ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ I strongly agree

64. 16. Because otherwise I will feel ashamed of myself.

Mark only one oval.

[illegible]

65. 17. Because putting efforts in this job has personal significance to me.

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
I str	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	I strongly agree

66. 18. Because the work I do is interesting.

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
I str	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	I strongly agree

67. 19. Because otherwise I will feel bad about myself.

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
I str	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	I strongly agree

Energy and fatigue level

The following questions are about how you have been during the last 4 weeks.

For this part of the questionnaire, please answer the questions using the following scale:

1 = Never

2 = Seldom

3 = Sometimes

4 = Often

5 = Always

68. 1. How often have you felt worn out?

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Never ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Always

69. 2. How often have you been physically exhausted?

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Never ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Always

70. 3. How often have you been emotionally exhausted?

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Never ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Always

71. 4. How often have you felt tired?

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Never ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Always

Attitudes towards life and work

In the final part of this questionnaire you are asked to describe some of your normal behaviours, attitudes and habits, particularly in regard to your work. These are formulated as a list of statements. Please indicate to what extent these statements apply to you personally.

For this part of the questionnaire, please rate the statements using the following scale:

1 = I strongly disagree

2 = I somewhat disagree

3 = I'm in the middle

4 = I somewhat agree

5 = I strongly agree

72. 1. For me, work is the most important part of life.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

73. 2. As far as my professional development is concerned, I consider myself to be fairly ambitious.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

74. 3. If necessary, I work until exhaustion.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

75. 4. My work should always be faultless.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

76. 5. I continue thinking about work problems during my leisure time.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

77. 6. If I am not successful, I give up quickly.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

78. 7. Lack of success can give me new determination.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

79. 8. I don't get upset easily.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

80. 9. So far, my professional life has been fairly successful.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

81. 10. I have every reason to be optimistic about my future.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

82. 11. My partner (or my closest person) is understanding about my work.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

83. 12. Work is everything to me.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

84. 13. I aspire to higher career goals than most other people.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

85. 14. I don't go easy on myself at work.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

86. 15. I prefer to check everything three times over rather than hand in work that contains mistakes.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

87. 16. After work I can switch off easily.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

88. 17. I find it difficult to cope with lack of success.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

89. 18. If I don't succeed at something, I remain persistent and try even harder.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

90. 19. I consider myself to be rather scatterbrained.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

91. 20. Up to this point in my career, I have experienced more successes than disappointments.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

92. 21. I cannot complain about my life in any way.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

93. 22. My family isn't very interested in my problems at work.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

94. 23. I need work like the air I breathe.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

95. 24. I have great plans for my career.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

96. 25. I probably work more than I should.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

97. 26. Whatever I do, it must be perfect.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

98. 27. Problems at work actually occupy my mind all day.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

99. 28. Failures at work can easily discourage me.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

100. 29. Lack of success doesn't bring me down, but makes me to try even harder.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

101. 30. The hustle and bustle around me doesn't affect me.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

102. 31. So far, I have succeeded at almost everything in my professional development.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

103. 32. So far, I can be satisfied with my life.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

104. 33. I would like my partner (or my closest person) to have more consideration for my work duties and challenges.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

105. 34. I wouldn't know how to live without work.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

106. 35. Professional success is an important aim in my life.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

107. 36. I tend to overwork.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

108. 37. I don't consider my work to be finished until I am completely satisfied with the result.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

109. 38. My thoughts revolve around work almost exclusively.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

110. 39. When I'm unsuccessful at work, it makes me feel very down.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

111. 40. If I don't succeed at something, that just makes me all the more determined.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

112. 41. I can be calm and collected in almost all situations.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

113. 42. My life up till now has been characterized by professional success.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

114. 43. By and large, I am happy and content.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

115. 44. I have the full support of my family.

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

I str ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ I strongly agree

Space for your further comment

116. What bothers you most about your work at a higher education institution at the moment? What do you like most?

117. If you would like to receive information about the results of the research, please specify the email address where you would like the results to be sent to.

The contact details provided will be immediately separated from the questionnaire responses and used only for the purposes of this research. It is also possible to send a request for the results of the survey to the following email address:
gabriele.beer@kphvie.ac.at.

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